Apart Sprint Evaluation Rubric

▼ Reviewer Guidance

- We **score along three different dimensions, from 1 (worst) to 5 (best)**.
- **Score dimensions independently**: a 5 on Execution isn't always a 5 on Impact or Presentation
- For Impact & Innovation, focus on **potential impact on AI safety and security**. A quick search may help to assess novelty for areas you're less familiar with.
- **Quality over quantity**: A focused 4-page submission often beats a noisy 10-page one.
  - Verbosity that obscures substance → subtract from **Presentation**
  - Scattered experiments that don't add up → subtract from **Execution**
- **Calibration**:
  - **Level 3 = solid** hackathon work ← what you'd expect from a competent team in a weekend
  - **Level 5 = exceptional** ← we expect no more than ~5-10% of projects to reach this quality bar for any given scoring dimension

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Dimension 1: Impact Potential & Innovation

How much would this matter for AI safety if it worked? How innovative is it?
For scores of 4-5: is this actually new to the field, or replicating recent work?

Score	Description
1	**Negligible.** No clear problem addressed, or no meaningful novelty.
2	**Limited.** Addresses a real problem but with a generic or well-trodden approach. Incremental at best.
3	**Moderate.** Clear problem with a reasonable approach; some novelty in framing or method beyond routine application of existing tools.
4	**Significant.** Important problem with an original approach, or identifies a neglected problem area. A valuable contribution others could build on.
5	**Exceptional.** Tackles a critical AI safety problem with a genuinely novel approach, or opens a new research direction. Clear theory of change. You'd be excited to share this with researchers in the area.

Dimension 2: Execution Quality

How sound are methodology, implementation, and findings?

Score	Description
1	**Seriously flawed.** Methodology broken, results uninterpretable, or implementation doesn't work.
2	**Weak.** Approach has significant gaps: missing validation, flawed experimental design, or incomplete implementation.
3	**Competent.** Technically solid given the short duration. Methodology makes sense, results are interpretable, limitations acknowledged, work builds toward clear conclusions.
4	**Strong.** Thorough methodology with convincing validation. Results clearly support conclusions. Immediately useful for future work.
5	**Exceptional.** Ambitious scope executed rigorously. Surprising findings, novel methods, or unusually robust validation.

Dimension 3: Presentation & Clarity

How clearly are work, findings, and impact potential communicated?

Score	Description
1	**Incomprehensible.** Cannot determine what the project is actually claiming or doing.
2	**Hard to follow.** Key information buried, missing, or diluted by excessive length. Significant effort to extract main points.
3	**Clear enough.** Can understand the problem, approach, and results without undue effort. Core content clearly present: problem, method, findings, limitations.
4	**Well presented.** Easy to follow, well-structured, appropriate level of detail. Target audience would get it quickly.
5	**Exceptionally clear.** A pleasure to read. Complex ideas made accessible. Could serve as a model for how to present this type of work.

▼ Flags

(checkbox, not scored)

□ **Off-topic**: Project does not fit any track for the current hackathon.

- Off-topic projects are still judged on their merits (can still achieve high scores) but